

## Topic to discuss

- Richardson Extrapolation
- Richardson with forward difference
- Richardson with Backward difference
- Richardson with central difference

## Richardson Extrapolation

It is a technique used to improve the accuracy of a numerical approximation by combining results obtained with different step sizes.

We can estimate derivatives of a function using forward / backward difference but

- without Richardson, forward / backward are less accurate
- With Richardson, their accuracy improves
- Central difference + Richardson is usually best here

### Richardson formula :

If an approximation  $D(h)$  has error of order  $O(h^n)$ , then

$$D_{\text{rich}} = \frac{2^n D(h/2) - D(h)}{2^n - 1}$$

Another form, using  $h$  and  $\gamma h$ ,  
Instead of  $h/2$ , we reduce step size to  $\gamma h$ , where  $0 < \gamma < 1$ , then

$$D_{\text{rich}} = \frac{D(\gamma h) - \gamma^n D(h)}{1 - \gamma^n}$$

This is the general form,

If  $x = \frac{1}{2}$  then,

$$\begin{aligned} D_{rich} &= \frac{D(xh) - x^n D(h)}{1 - x^n} \\ &= \frac{D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^n D(h)}{1 - \left(\frac{1}{2}\right)^n} \end{aligned}$$

Multiply numerator and denominator by  $2^n$ ,

$$D_{rich} = \frac{2^n D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - D(h)}{2^n - 1}$$



## How to choose 'n' value

It depends on the error order of the original method.

→ forward difference for first derivative:  
error  $O(h)$  →  $n=1$

→ Backward difference for first derivative,  
error  $O(h)$  →  $n=1$

→ Three-point central difference for first derivative,  
error  $O(h^2)$  →  $n=2$

### Numerical Problem :

Q: Estimate the value of  $f'(x)$  at  $x=0.5$  using given data:

| $x$        | 0      | 0.25   | 0.5    | 0.75   | 1.0    |
|------------|--------|--------|--------|--------|--------|
| $f(x)=e^x$ | 1.0000 | 1.2840 | 1.6487 | 2.1170 | 2.7183 |

assume  $h=0.5$  and  $x=1/2$ .

Solve it using

- 1) forward difference
- 2) Backward difference
- 3) Central difference / three point

Solution: ① forward difference,

forward difference formula,

$$D(h) = \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h}$$

for  $n=1$ , and  $\gamma = \frac{1}{2}$ ,

$$D_{rich} = \frac{D(\gamma h) - \gamma^n D(h)}{1 - \gamma^n}$$

$$D_{rich} = \frac{D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - \frac{1}{2} \times D(h)}{1 - \frac{1}{2}}$$

$$D_{rich} = 2D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - D(h)$$

Now, we have to find  $D(h)$  &  $D(h/2)$

We have,  $h = 0.5$  &  $h/2 = 0.25$

$$\begin{aligned} D(h) &= \frac{f(x+h) - f(x)}{h} = \frac{f(0.5+0.5) - f(0.5)}{0.5} \\ &= \frac{f(1) - f(0.5)}{0.5} = \frac{2.7183 - 1.6487}{0.5} \end{aligned}$$

$$D(h) = 2.1392$$

and

$$\begin{aligned} D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) &= \frac{f\left(x + \frac{h}{2}\right) - f(x)}{\frac{h}{2}} = \frac{f(0.75) - f(0.5)}{0.25} \\ &= \frac{2.1170 - 1.6487}{0.25} \end{aligned}$$

$$D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) = 1.8732$$

$$\begin{aligned}\text{So, } D_{\text{rich}} &= 2D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - D(h) \\ &= 2 \times 1.8732 - 2.1392 \\ &= 1.6072\end{aligned}$$

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③ Central difference / three point,

$$D(h) = \frac{f(x+h) - f(x-h)}{2h}$$

So,  $n=2$  and  $r=\frac{1}{2}$

$$D_{rich} = \frac{D(rh) - r^n D(h)}{1 - r^n}$$
$$= \frac{D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - \frac{1}{4} D(h)}{1 - \frac{1}{4}}$$

$$D_{rich} = \frac{4 D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - D(h)}{3}$$



We have to find  $D(h)$  &  $D(h/2)$

also,  $h = 0.5$  &  $h/2 = 0.25$

$$\begin{aligned} D(h) &= \frac{f(x+h) - f(x-h)}{2h} \\ &= \frac{f(0.5+0.5) - f(0.5-0.5)}{2 \times 0.5} \\ &= \frac{f(1) - f(0)}{1} = \frac{2.7183 - 1.0000}{1} \end{aligned}$$

$$\therefore D(h) = 1.7183$$

now,

$$\begin{aligned} D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) &= \frac{f\left(x + \frac{h}{2}\right) - f\left(x - \frac{h}{2}\right)}{2 \times \frac{h}{2}} \\ &= \frac{f(0.75) - f(0.25)}{0.5} \\ &= \frac{2.1170 - 1.2840}{0.5} = 1.6660 \end{aligned}$$

Now,

$$D_{rich} = \frac{4D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) - D(h)}{3}$$

$$= \frac{4 \times 1.6660 - 1.7183}{3}$$

$$\approx 1.6485667$$

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Homework (2) Solve using backward difference,

$$D(h) = \frac{f(x) - f(x-h)}{h}$$

$$D_{rich} = \frac{D(\gamma h) - \gamma D(h)}{1-\gamma}$$

for  $\gamma = \frac{1}{2}$ ,

$$D_{rich} = 2D(h/2) - D(h)$$

Now, we have to find,  $D(h)$  &  $D(h/2)$

$$\therefore D(h) = \frac{f(0.5) - f(0.5-0.5)}{0.5}$$

$$\therefore D(h) = \frac{f(0.5) - f(0)}{0.5}$$

$$= \frac{1.6487 - 1.0000}{0.5}$$

$$= 1.2974$$

$$\text{and } D\left(\frac{h}{2}\right) = \frac{f(x) - f\left(x - \frac{h}{2}\right)}{h/2}$$

$$= \frac{f(0.5) - f(0.25)}{0.25}$$

$$= \frac{1.6487 - 1.2840}{0.25}$$

$$\therefore D(h/2) = 1.4588$$

Now,

$$D_{rich} = 2D(h/2) - D(h)$$

$$= 2 \times 1.4588 - 1.2974$$

$$= 1.6202$$

Ans.

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### Summary :

Forward + Richardson  $\rightarrow 1.6072$

Backward + Richardson  $\rightarrow 1.6202$

Central + Richardson  $\rightarrow 1.6486$

Now, exact solution,

$$f(x) = e^x$$

$$f'(x) = e^x$$

$$= e^{0.5} = 1.6487$$

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